LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience building batch and streaming data platforms across logistics, payments and retail. Owns production ingestion and orchestration using Airflow, dbt, Snowflake and Kafka, with hands-on AWS experience. Delivers reusable tooling, tested data models and data contracts that improve reliability, performance and cost. AWS Certified Data Engineer - Associate.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. | 03/2022 - present

Logistics marketplace

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform, including approximately 140 Airflow DAGs loading PostgreSQL, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party API data into Snowflake; participate in the on-call rotation one week in six.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into dbt; the platform now has 420+ models with tests on every model. Introduced incremental models, documentation and slim CI in GitHub Actions, cutting nightly builds from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Introduced data contracts using JSON Schema and CI checks between product teams and the data team, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine to two per month.
- Designed and built a Kafka event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming, processing approximately 30 million shipment events per day with p95 end-to-end latency under two minutes. Added dead-letter handling and replay tooling.
- Replaced hourly full-table PostgreSQL extracts with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced the monthly Snowflake bill from approximately 38k to 24k through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables in 2024.
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers and run weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay | 09/2019 - 02/2022

Payments startup

- Built PySpark transaction reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files daily from S3; reduced month-end manual reconciliation from approximately three days to four hours.
- Designed a dimensional Redshift warehouse with a star schema and 30+ fact and dimension tables for finance and risk.
- Implemented Great Expectations data quality checks on critical finance tables.
- Developed a reusable internal Python library for S3 and Glue Data Catalog access, adopted by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer | Adria Retail Group | 06/2017 - 08/2019

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL for an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations across 40+ stores.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash

Data platform: Airflow, dbt, Snowflake, Redshift, PySpark, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Snowpipe Streaming

Data modelling and quality: Dimensional modelling, star schemas, incremental models, data contracts, JSON Schema, Great Expectations

Cloud and engineering: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, pytest, Terraform (basic)

Databases and BI: PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, Power BI, Looker (basic)

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer - Associate | May 2024

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) | Northgate Technical University | 2017

Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

OPEN SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider package in 2023, fixing an API pagination bug and adding tests.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.
- Teach beginner SQL at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)